

Document: Commission looks to boost quality over price in public procurement

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By Aude van den Hove, Francesca Micheletti · Sep 8, 2026, 11:18 AM · [View in your browser](#)

BRUSSELS — The European Commission’s plans to make quality and European preference central pillars of its revised public procurement framework are still on track, according to the latest draft of the Public Procurement Act obtained by POLITICO .

The Commission will unveil the proposed overhaul of its procurement rules on Wednesday, alongside a new Innovation Act, which would seek to leverage government contracts to bring innovations to market faster.

The new draft of the procurement act is substantially similar to a version from July and has mainly cosmetic changes. It is about 40 pages shorter than the previous version, as it is missing a ‘Legislative financial and digital statement.’

For the rest, the core message remains the same: contracts would generally be awarded on the basis of the best price-to-quality ratio.

Contracting authorities would be required to give quality criteria a minimum weighting of 30 percent, rising to 50 percent for labor-intensive contracts, unless they can justify relying on price alone.

Environmental, social, innovation, security and resilience considerations would all count towards the quality assessment, embedding strategic policy objectives into procurement decisions.

Contracting authorities are also authorized to restrict tender participation to EU and other treaty-covered suppliers as well as call for minimum EU or “covered” origin for goods and services.

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